

THE ULTIMATE

RANGE ROVER L322 2004 BUYERS GUIDE

BMW M62 ERA - Last of the BMW Years

20 Pages | 100+ Checks | Real Workshop Costs

THE INTERNATIONAL
PORSCHE GARAGE

■■■■■■■ British Workshop Tested | England Flag Garage Series

SHOP THIS GUIDE'S TOOLS & PARTS:

<https://ebay.us/m/kke7s5>

Comment 'L322' on Instagram for your free copy

PAGE 01 - WHY THE 2004 MATTERS

The 2004 L322 is the final year of BMW ownership. It runs the BMW M62TU B44 4.4 V8 and ZF 5HP24 5-speed - not the later Jaguar 4.4. This matters because parts, diagnostics, and failure points are completely different.

WHY PEOPLE BUY IT:

- Last BMW engine - simpler than Jag AJ41
- Cheapest entry into L322 - £3000-£6000 market
- Classic looks, modern luxury

WHY THEY SCRAP IT:

- Timing chain guides (£4000+)
- Gearbox failure (90% never serviced)
- Air suspension + electrics = battery drain

STANDARD TEMPLATE - OUR INSPECTION SYSTEM:

Every section uses: HOOK / WHAT TO WATCH / RED FLAG / PRO TIP / COST IF YOU MISS IT / eBay TOOL LINK

eBay Store Essentials for this page: IIDTool / AllComms diagnostic - <https://ebay.us/m/kke7s5>

PAGE 02 - VIN, HISTORY & PAPERWORK

HOOK: No history = no deal. Cheap L322s have expensive secrets.

WHAT TO WATCH FOR:

- VIN SALLMAMA... check 10th digit = 4 for 2004
- Service book - should have Land Rover + specialist stamps every 10k
- 2 keys - new key is £350 + coding at dealer
- MOT history online - look for advisories repeating
- HPI check - finance, stolen, written off

RED FLAGS:

- 3+ owners in 2 years = flipped lemon
- Fresh underseal, no photos underneath

PRO TIP:

Call the last garage on the invoice. Ask 'Would you buy it back?'. Their pause tells you everything.

COST IF YOU MISS IT: £2000+ hidden

TOOL: HPI Check + Diagnostic Scanner - Shop: <https://ebay.us/m/kke7s5>

PAGE 03 - ENGINE M62TU B44 - THE BIG ONE

HOOK: If it rattles for 2 seconds on cold start, walk away.

WHAT TO WATCH FOR:

- Cold start rattle 0-5 sec = timing chain guides disintegrated. Plastic goes into oil pickup.
- Valley pan coolant leak - look down V of engine with torch
- PCV system - remove oil cap at idle. Excessive vacuum or howling = failed
- Vanos rattle at 1500rpm
- White sludge under oil cap = short trips / PCV

RED FLAGS: Overheated, coolant smell, mayo everywhere, oil light flicker

PRO TIP: Check coolant level cold. Then squeeze top hose - should be firm, not rock hard (head gasket).

COST: Chain guides £3500-5500 | Valley pan £600-900 | PCV £180 | Vanos £800

PARTS: Timing kit, valley pan gasket, PCV kit - <https://ebay.us/m/kke7s5>

PAGE 04 - COOLING SYSTEM

HOOK: One overheat warps the block.

WHAT TO WATCH FOR:

- Expansion tank cracked at bottom
- Viscous fan - should roar on cold start then quiet
- Thermostat stuck open = temp never reaches middle
- Aux water pump leaking
- All hoses original = 20 years old, will fail

TEST: Let it idle to full temp with heater on full. Should stay dead centre.

COST: Full cooling refresh £600-900

PARTS: Expansion tank, thermostat, hoses kit - <https://ebay.us/m/kke7s5>

PAGE 05 - GEARBOX ZF 5HP24

HOOK: This gearbox is why 90% of 2004s are scrapped.

WHAT TO WATCH FOR:

- 2-3 flare under light throttle
- Shudder at 35-45mph = torque converter
- Harsh downshift when stopping
- Failsafe message = low voltage or dying box
- Oil - pull dipstick (if accessible) - should be red, not brown/black

RED FLAGS: Fresh oil on old box (masking), 'just needs a reset'

PRO TIP: 20 min mixed drive, then do 10 slow stops 30-0. Any thump = valve body.

COST: Rebuild £3500-4500 | Converter £800 | Valve body £1200

PARTS: ZF filter kit, converter - <https://ebay.us/m/kke7s5>

PAGE 06 - DRIVETRAIN & 4WD

WHAT TO WATCH FOR:

- Front diff whine on overrun at 50-70mph - common, £800 fix
- Transfer case chain slap on tight turns
- Prop shaft centre bearing vibration at 60mph
- CV joints clicking on full lock

TEST: Full lock circles in car park both ways. Listen for clunk / whine.

COST: Front diff £600-1000 | Transfer chain £400 | Propshaft bearing £250

PARTS: Diff bearings, transfer case chain - <https://ebay.us/m/kke7s5>

PAGE 07 - AIR SUSPENSION

HOOK: 'Air Suspension Inactive' = £1000 minimum.

WHAT TO WATCH FOR:

- Sag overnight on one corner = airbag leaking
- Compressor runs constantly = worn out + dryer saturated
- Height sensors - plastic arm snapped, corrosion
- Compressor relay burned
- Car leans after parked 2 hours

PRO TIP: Cycle Off-road > Normal > Access. Should rise in <30 sec each. Time it.

RED FLAGS: Coil conversion (devalued 30%), compressor bypass switch

COST: Compressor £350-450 | Bags £180 each | Sensors £90-120 | Valve block £280

PARTS: Dunlop airbags, AMK compressor - <https://ebay.us/m/kke7s5>

PAGE 08 - CHASSIS & SUBFRAME

WHAT TO WATCH FOR:

- Front subframe mounts rust - common MOT fail
- Rear subframe rot above exhaust
- Air tank cradle rust
- Brake pipes corroded along chassis
- Front lower arms bushes torn

CHECK: Torch + phone camera behind front wheels, look at subframe.

COST: Subframe repair £400-800 | Arms £200/side | Brake pipes £250

PARTS: Subframe bushes, arms, pipes - <https://ebay.us/m/kke7s5>

PAGE 09 - ELECTRICS & BECM

HOOK: Sunroof drains flood the electrics and kill the car.

WHAT TO WATCH FOR:

- Battery drain overnight - BECM not sleeping (>50mA draw)
- Steering column adjustment dead = module
- Door locks bouncing up/down = latch
- Fuel flap not opening
- Sat nav MK3 black screen, radio no sound
- Water in boot = sunroof drains blocked (rear drains exit behind bumper)

PRO TIP: Pull boot carpet, check spare wheel well for water + condensation on BECM cover.

COST: BECM £800+ | Latches £120 each | Column module £250

PARTS: Door latches, BECM repair - <https://ebay.us/m/kke7s5>

PAGE 10 - INTERIOR & TOYS

WHAT TO WATCH FOR:

- Heated screens - both front and rear, check elements
- Heated seats - both sides, high and low
- AC blows cold - compressor clutch common
- All windows + sunroof operation
- Seat memory + steering memory sync
- Dash pixels - missing lines = instrument cluster

PRO TIP: Every button must work. Each button is £80-200 used.

COST: Instrument cluster £300 | Heater pack £250

PARTS: Switch packs, screens - <https://ebay.us/m/kke7s5>

PAGE 11 - RUST - THE KILLER

HOOK: They rot from the inside out.

WHAT TO WATCH FOR:

- Upper & lower tailgate seam - open tailgate, look at seam inside
- Rear wheel arches inside lip - run finger, rough = rust
- Front inner wings behind arch liner - torch needed
- Boot floor under spare - lift it
- Windscreen scuttle - leaks into ECU box
- Sills under plastic covers

RED FLAGS: Fresh paint on tailgate, filler in arches, underseal overspray on exhaust

COST: Tailgate £600-900 | Arches £500-700/side | Sills £400-600

PARTS: Tailgate repair panels, arch liners - <https://ebay.us/m/kke7s5>

PAGE 12 - BRAKES & HUBS

WHAT TO WATCH FOR:

- Brembo front judder at 60mph = warped discs
- Handbrake - electronic? Actually 2004 is manual drum in disc, seizes
- ABS sensor light = hub / sensor
- Brake pipes corroded (MOT fail)
- Wheel bearings drone at speed

COST: Discs + pads £400-600 | Bearings £200/corner | Handbrake shoes £150

PARTS: Brembo kit, bearings - <https://ebay.us/m/kke7s5>

PAGE 13 - TEST DRIVE PROTOCOL

THE 15-MINUTE TEST THAT SAVES YOU £5000:

1. Cold start - bonnet up, listen 0-10 sec for chain rattle
2. All dash lights self-test then OFF
3. All suspension heights - Access/Normal/Off-road - time each
4. Every button - windows, sunroof, heated screens/seats, mirrors, steering column
5. Drive: 0-30 gentle, 30-60 full throttle, 60-0 brake, 30-0 x10 slow stops
6. 60mph cruise - vibration = prop
7. Full lock circles both ways - whine/click
8. Scan with IIDTool - screenshot faults

TOOL: IIDTool BT / Gap - Essential: <https://ebay.us/m/kke7s5>

PAGE 14 - NEGOTIATION

Use faults list as weapon:

- No history = 30% off asking
- Chain rattle = walk or £4000 off
- Gearbox flare = £3000 off
- Air suspension inactive = £1000 off
- Any rust = £500 per panel off
- Water in boot = £800 off

SCRIPT:

'I've inspected a few L322s. This one needs £X to make right. I have cash at £Y, and I have a diagnostic report.'

Never show excitement. Always have 2 others to see.

PAGE 15 - IF YOU BUY IT - DAY 1 SERVICES

Do these immediately:

1. Oil + filter - 5W30 LL04, Mahle filter
2. Coolant flush + new cap + expansion tank if cloudy
3. Gearbox service - ZF filter + Lifeguard 5 oil
4. Diff oils + transfer case oil
5. Clear sunroof drains with curtain wire + compressed air
6. New battery - AGM 019, 100Ah minimum
7. Full diagnostic scan + clear + re-scan after 50 miles

COST: £600-800 DIY | £1200 garage

ALL SERVICE KITS: <https://ebay.us/m/kke7s5>

PAGE 16 - REAL COST OF OWNERSHIP

Item	DIY	Garage	eBay Link
Chain Guides	£1200	£4500	ebay.us/m/kke7s5
Gearbox Rebuild	-	£4000	ebay.us/m/kke7s5
Air Suspension Full	£800	£1800	ebay.us/m/kke7s5
Rust Repair	-	£1500-3000	ebay.us/m/kke7s5
Cooling Refresh	£350	£800	ebay.us/m/kke7s5
Brakes All Round	£400	£700	ebay.us/m/kke7s5

Budget £1500/year maintenance on a good one. £3000/year on a cheap one.

PAGE 17 - 35-POINT CHECKLIST (PRINT THIS)

- Cold start rattle (0-5 sec) ■ Valley pan leak ■ PCV vacuum ■ Coolant level/colour ■ Oil cap mayo
- Expansion tank crack ■ Fan roar ■ 2-3 flare ■ Torque shudder ■ Failsafe
- Front diff whine ■ Transfer chain ■ Prop vibration ■ Air sag overnight ■ Compressor time
- All heights work ■ Height sensors ■ Subframe rust ■ Brake pipes ■ Arms bushes
- Battery drain ■ Steering column ■ Door locks ■ Water in boot ■ Sunroof drains
- Heated screens/seats ■ AC cold ■ All windows ■ Dash pixels ■ Nav screen
- Tailgate rust ■ Arches lip ■ Inner wings ■ Boot floor ■ Sills

Download printable version: <https://ebay.us/m/kke7s5> - comment L322

PAGE 18 - OUR EBAY STORE - WHAT WE USE

We test everything in our England flag workshop. These are the parts we actually use:

DIAGNOSTICS:

- IIDTool BT, AllComms, Foxwell - <https://ebay.us/m/kke7s5>

ENGINE:

- Timing chain kit M62, valley pan, PCV, Vanos seals - <https://ebay.us/m/kke7s5>

GEARBOX & DRIVETRAIN:

- ZF 5HP24 filter + Lifeguard 5 oil, front diff bearings - <https://ebay.us/m/kke7s5>

SUSPENSION:

- Dunlop airbags, AMK compressor, height sensors, valve block - <https://ebay.us/m/kke7s5>

RUST & BODY:

- Tailgate repair panels, arch liners, brake pipes - <https://ebay.us/m/kke7s5>

Click any link or scan QR below. Supports the garage, same price for you.

PAGE 19-20 - YOUR NEXT STEPS

HOW TO GET YOUR COPY:

1. Comment 'L322' on our Instagram reel
2. Follow @theinternationalporsche
3. Check DMs - we auto-send this PDF

WANT US TO FIND ONE FOR YOU?

We offer video inspections. £199 - we go check the car with this guide + live video.

JOIN THE GARAGE:

YouTube: The International Porsche Garage

Instagram: @theinternationalporsche

eBay Store (Parts + Tools): <https://ebay.us/m/kke7s5>

■■■■■■■■ Built in our British workshop with the England flag flying. Every check is real world, not theory.

Thank you - Hardman PK

Palm Coast, FL | British Workshop Series